

Executive Summary: Two alerts captured reconnaissance activity originating from IP 203.0.113.99 targeting your firewall and public web server, consistent with pre-attack intelligence gathering. An external actor is actively probing your network perimeter, which typically precedes a targeted attack and could lead to unauthorized access or data compromise.

Status:	CONFIRMED	Confidence:	85%
Pattern:	Reconnaissance & Pre-Attack Intelligence Gathering		
Vector:	RECON		
Risk:	LOW		
LLM Enhanced:	Yes (claude-haiku-4-5-20251001)		

Business Impact: Critical operational risk affecting organizational assets.

Analyst Executive Assessment:

The detected activity shows early-stage adversary reconnaissance against both your network edge and public-facing application. While no exploitation or data theft has occurred, this pattern is a known precursor to more serious attacks. The external IP has not yet attempted to move laterally or breach systems, but the targeting of both your firewall and web server suggests the actor is mapping your infrastructure. This warrants immediate visibility into what information was exposed and whether any follow-up probing occurs. The low current severity reflects the absence of confirmed compromise, but the operational risk is real if reconnaissance leads to a subsequent attack.

Affected Services: Network perimeter security, public web presence
Operational Risk: Moderate probability of follow-on attack attempt within 72 hours if reconnaissance succeeds
Blast Radius: 2 assets across external and DMZ segments; potential impact to customer-facing services if attack progresses

Why It Matters: An external actor is actively probing your network perimeter, which typically precedes a targeted attack and could lead to unauthorized access or data compromise.

What Was Detected: Two alerts captured reconnaissance activity originating from IP 203.0.113.99 targeting your firewall and public web server, consistent with pre-attack intelligence gathering.

Immediate Response Actions:

- Add 203.0.113.99 to firewall deny list at perimeter (fw-ext-01.corp.local ingress rules)
- Enable enhanced logging on www.corp.com web server and firewall for all traffic from 203.0.113.99
- Isolate fw-ext-01.corp.local and www.corp.com for deep packet inspection and behavioral analysis

Key Message: An external attacker is actively surveying your network; take immediate defensive steps to deny reconnaissance success and prepare for potential follow-on attack attempts.

Window: 14:00 – 14:02

Top Risk Categories: LOW_RECON Reconnaissance & Pre-Attack Intelligence 0.85 Gathering

Trigger Timeline:

Timestamp	Alert ID	Category	Tier
2026-04-24 14:00:00	W401	informationgathering	LOW
2026-04-24 14:02:00	W402	informationgathering	LOW

Strategic Recommendations:

- Block IP 203.0.113.99 at the perimeter and review firewall logs for the past 7 days to identify what was probed Security Operations
- Scan both affected assets (fw-ext-01 and www.corp.com) for unauthorized changes or backdoors installed during reconnaissance Infrastructure Security
- Brief executive leadership on the reconnaissance activity and establish a 48-hour escalation protocol if additional probing from this or related IPs is detected CISO Office

Regulatory Impact:

NIS2 No immediate obligation - log for annual report
GDPR No direct impact expected
DORA No immediate impact

Scope

Total alerts 2

